

Sitting in Britannia's old corporate office in Bengaluru's Old Airport Road neighbourhood (the newer one is in faraway Whitefield), Berry gently sips on a dairy variant the company recently launched—Winkin' Cow's almond salted caramel milkshake. Nodding his head in approval, he is glad you have liked it as well. The large office, reminiscent of an era gone by and characterised by formality, is in stark contrast to Berry's collared T-shirt and blazer. Joining him is Britannia's CEO & Executive Director Rajneet Singh Kohli, who came aboard last September from Domino's, preceded by a long stint at Coca-Cola. "My mandate is to sustain the transformation at Britannia from a digital point of view. We must be innovative and provide value to the customer and employees," he states. As he, too, indulges in the milkshake, Kohli speaks of the plan to launch a cold coffee flavour. "The idea is to democratise consumers and at ₹40, it will be very competitively priced." Interestingly, the Winkin' Cow brand name was chosen after the teams sat in a room undisturbed for six hours when the initial options did not make the cut.

26 |

Britannia entered the dairy business in 1997, albeit the turnover is still only ₹600 crore or 4 per cent of the total, despite multiple launches and relaunches. "The truth is we have not done enough, but the good thing is we make money," says Berry. This segment is familiar territory to Berry. At PepsiCo, he ran the dairy and juice business in many geographies including India through a joint venture with Saudi Arabia's Almarai. However, convincing the Britannia board to invest in dairy was arduous. "It was the longest project I ever worked on," he confesses.

For about seven years, he made 34 presentations. "By then, I had met every dairy manufacturer across the world and the feedback was uniform. They said Britannia was a good bakery company, but were unconvinced about what we could do in dairy," recalls Berry with exasperation.

Till then, the company's dairy business was a contract manufacturing model, most of it (primarily cheese and curd) coming from Schreiber Dynamix's plant in Baramati, about 100 km from Pune. The Britannia board heard Berry out patiently each time before asking the same question—why would you want to invest ₹700 crore in a new plant when the revenue is lower and not growing? "There was interest but obviously a trigger was required," he says. The trigger was provided by the government setting up a food park in Ranjangaon and giving incentives. A ₹700-crore plant was set up in Ranjangaon, an industrial area in Maharashtra. Each

NEW BATCHES

Some recent launches by Britannia Industries



BISCUIT

Bisafe, NutriChoice
Seeds, Herbs & Protein

CAKE

Festive plum cake



SNACKING

Tic Tac Toe

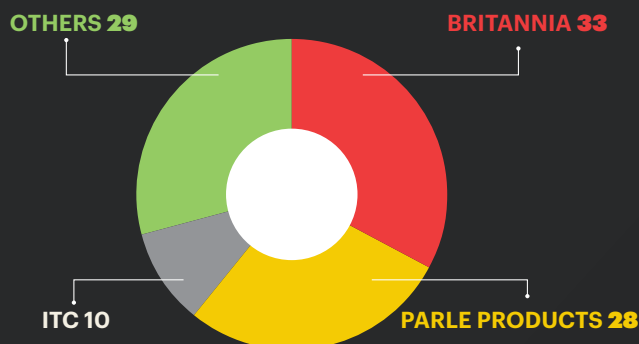
DAIRY

Fresh paneer



CUTTING UP THE COOKIE

With a 33 per cent market share, Britannia is the leader in India's ₹42,000-crore organised biscuits market



CURRENT MARKET SHARE IN PER CENT
SOURCE: INDUSTRY